



Mindset & Behavioral Change in Development

Concept Note



“
SOUND MIND
EMPOWERED
FOR VIBRANT
COUNTRY

”

Concept Note

Mindset & Behavioral Change in Development

Implementing Agency: Arise Dignity Initiative in Development

Geographical coverage	Uganda, West Nile (Nebbi District)
Project duration (in months)	6 Months (August 2022 to February 2023)



ARISE DIGNITY INITIATIVES IN DEVELOPMENT (ADID)

1. About ADID (ARISE DIGNITY INITIATIVES IN DEVELOPMENT)

ADID is a community based initiative set up to help young mothers and young fathers to arise, feel confident and trying to rehabilitate them into being better people to enable them to take on their responsibilities.

(a) VISION:

A Sound mind, empowered for a vibrant country."

(b) MISSION of ARISE DIGNITY INITIATIVES IN DEVELOPMENT

"To promote a positive attitude and mindset change, instil hope, advance the improvement of community health, education, behavioral change and support sustainable community development to alleviate poverty."

(c) GOAL: To inspire, inform, advance knowledge and support our communities.

2. OBJECTIVES

- a) Carry out behavioral change campaigns to change mindsets and instil ethical and moral values.
- b) To inspire, empower and support household generating projects to alleviate poverty especially for the marginalized groups.
- c) To contribute to health and well-being by promoting hygienic practices and prevention of communicable and non-communicable diseases.
- d) To explore emerging technologies and opportunities that will enhance schools programs and expand students' capabilities.
- e) To undertake activities that build the capacity of Arise Dignity Initiatives in Development and allow it to effectively pursue its objectives.

3. PROJECT OVERVIEW/ SUMMARY

Mindset Change for Development is a project which aims at empowering people through various activities and services with the aim of instilling positive mentality or attitudes towards personal, communal spheres for national development.

The right mindset means choosing growth over negativity. Positive thinking, or an optimistic attitude, is the practice of focusing on the good in any given situation.

Nebbi District in North West of Uganda happens to be lagging behind all the fronts of development and as such has been selected among the many for the inaugural project flagship launch of the project.



4. Problem

According to the Ministry of Health, **25 per cent of Ugandan teenagers become pregnant by the age of 19**. Close to half are married before their 18th birthday and continue having babies into their mid-40s. The teenage pregnancy rate of 25% in Uganda is worrying though it may seem low compared to 28% in Sub-Saharan countries and West and Central Africa.

Nebbi District found in the West Nile region of Uganda has population of over 290,000 people however most of these young stricken with a series of issues ranging from teenage and unplanned pregnancies, early child marriages, increased rate of drug and substance abuse, lack of safe water, lack of viable economic activities to participate in among others.

Uganda's population has 70% of young people who have no access to right information and this had led to the poor outcomes for the interventions that have been laid in solving these challenges

Important to note also, mindset and behavioral change have not been given the attention by both government and civil society so as to fully consolidate the efforts to improve the life of people in Nebbi. Most of the youth in Nebbi live an empty life with little or no hope at all to steer their future ahead.

We therefore believe that the Mindset Change for development will not only catapult the people in Nebbi into development but also instil hope as they live a positive life full of dignity.



5. Our Approach/ Activities

We intend to carry out activities in line with the project goal which include; Using Debates, Dramas and Plays, Household mentoring and counselling, Community/ Town hall Barazas on mindset and behavioral change

i) **Using Debates, Dramas and Plays (The High School Crossfire Debates)**

The High School Cross Fire debate is an approach where youth in schools are supported to share with peers openly and freely, their experiences about SRH and related issues in their lives, learn about health promotion practices and make reflections on risks in their lives and how they can safely respond to those situations. This happens through debates, quizzes and peer led discussions at school and on media channels that include Television and radio discussions.

Through our High School Crossfire Debates we use platforms and approaches which empower young people to discover themselves, believe in themselves, and protect themselves from negative peer and adult influences which render them vulnerable to many SRH risks. These include early pregnancies and motherhood, Sexually Transmitted Infections (STIs) including HIV and alcohol and drug abuse to mention a few. We utilize the Enter-educate platforms during the engagement with the young people. These include music, motivational speakers' discussions and film shows.

ii) **Household Mentoring, Counselling on family upbringing.**

ADID strives to foster changes in the mindset of poor young mothers and fathers, improve their household, gender relations, self-esteem, towards active participation in personal development. Measures taken to adopt positive attitudes should aim at empowering the poor to break the cycle of poverty and engage in livelihood sources that prevent intergenerational poverty. The overall aim of mentorship sessions will be to improve the standard and sustainability of the livelihoods of poor rural households.



The mentors shall constitute community role models/champions, community empowerment group facilitators, community development officers, VHTs, sub county extension workers, leadership of farmers associations working to make a difference in the lives of community members.

iii) **Community/ Town hall Barazas on mindset and behavioral change.**

A communal approach to the concerns of the young mother and young fathers is a key to unlocking the underlying causes of a failed, degenerated and hopeless youthful society. We intend to have several town hall meetings, with the main purpose understanding the psychosocial challenges faced within the communities, the possible sustainable solutions and what can be done to reverse the trend. This approach will have all categories since the issues are trans generational with all the age groups having an input.

6. Target Area and Beneficiaries

Nebbi District in the West Nile region of Uganda with the direct beneficiaries being the young mothers, young fathers, out of school youths, students in schools. The other categories of beneficiaries include the religious leaders, opinion leaders and the general public.

7. Budget Overview

An estimated budget of **Ugx 187,000,000** for six months will be able to cover the ADID Mindset & Behavioral Change in Development project for the first 6 months.

Thank You.

